

Does turning off automated AI overview in google helps against the water waste?

Posted by u/ChildhoodFar7680 • 0 points • 1 comments

So I found out that you can turn off the AI overview in your account using:

Settings

\-> site search

\-> add

\-> Name: 'Web' , shortcut: '@web', URL : {google:baseURL}search?q=%s&udm=14

My question is wether this feature actually contributes to saving water by turning off the automated AI summaries OR it only turns off the display of them while they are still being generated in the background anyway? (It's still possible to click to 'AI mode' at any moment, but it's not really clear wether the response is generated or just showed after that click).

Comments

u/zackhesse • 2 points • 2026-02-25 19:04 UTC

Yes, you will save 10-20 mL of (evaporated, not "consumed") cooling water for every normal Google search you run without clicking the AI overview section this way. This is a lifecycle estimate looking at training, inference, and the power usage to run both.

I recommend the University of Maine's "What Uses More?" website to learn more about this number in context and from a reputable educational source.

For comparison, normal leakage from the plumbing of a median US home is around 100,000 mL per day, and the amortized water use to produce a cheeseburger is about 2,600,000 mL.